

- however, patriarchal domination is reflected in the crime where the victim is a woman with liberal views suggesting that when patriarchy is challenged women are targeted. The way in which her body is displayed representing a more traditional nuclear family, is relevant in reasserting stereotypical gender roles.

Van Zoonen's assertion that gender is constructed through discourse and that its meaning varies according to cultural and historical context can be applied to *The Bridge*:

- The construction of representations in *The Bridge* reflects the changing roles of men and women in society and challenges typical stereotypes of gender. The creation of Saga's character reflects the interest in society in the changing ideas and viewpoints regarding gender, reinforcing Van Zoonen's assertion that the meaning of gender varies according to cultural contexts.
- In *The Bridge*, contrary to Van Zoonen's claim, women are framed and constructed in a similar way to men. Women are active, not passive, they are not objects of the male gaze and it is they who drive the narrative forward. When Saga takes off her t-shirt, the gaze between Hanne and John is intra-diegetic, in bewilderment at her action, she is not objectified by the camera.

Theoretical Approaches: Gender performativity – Judith Butler

Butler's assertion that identity is performatively constructed and that there is no gender identity behind the expressions of gender can be explored in relation to *The Bridge*:

- Through the programme's inclusion of Helle Anker's narrative regarding gender identity, a discourse is opened up and debated within the programme focusing on the nature of gender. Hanne states regarding Anker, "*she was very active in the gender debate, LGBT issues. You know, there's not gender, only humans*".
- Saga subverts and challenges the accepted social norms regarding gender behaviour. The construction of her character through, for example, clothing, expression, and behaviour, challenges the typical representations of female characters in this genre.

PART 3: STARTING POINTS – Media Industries

Processes of production, distribution and circulation by organisations, groups, and individuals in a global context

Television is now a global industry and this globalisation has had a significant impact evident in:

- The global distribution of television products. There are now the means in place in the television industry to distribute products worldwide.
- Nordic Noir has gained global popularity regardless of the language barrier. Contemporary audiences are more accepting of sub-titles and BBC Four has been at the forefront of establishing Non-English-Language programmes as part of their schedule. Crime dramas including *The Killing* and *The Bridge* have become an important element of BBC Four's brand identity with trailers reinforcing it as the home of Nordic Noir.
- The BBC Four Service Licence, issued in April 2016 states: 'BBC Four's primary role is to reflect a range of UK and international arts, music and culture'. Part of its remit is to 'offer international and foreign language feature films and a range of foreign language dramas and documentaries... Foreign language output should regularly be subtitled, including in peak-time, to allow people from around the world to be heard in their own voices'.
http://downloads.bbc.co.uk/bbctrust/assets/files/pdf/regulatory_framework/service_licences/tv/2016/bbcfour_apr16.pdf
- *The Bridge* was originally broadcast by SVT in Sweden and DR in Denmark. The settings, cast and crew taken from both countries reflect the economic context in which *The Bridge* was produced and helped to shape the programme. The UK broadcaster was BBC Four.
- The main distributor was ZDF Enterprises, and *The Bridge* was distributed to over 150 countries worldwide.
- A range of marketing strategies including posters, trailers and a website were used to attract and maintain audiences focusing on:
 - In the UK, the BBC Four branding connoting recognition of quality
 - The team of detectives establishing a sense of community and an ensemble, but in some of the marketing products with Saga in the forefront
 - The character of Saga as the troubled anti-hero
 - The Swedish/Danish setting with the iconic image of the Oresund Bridge
 - The *Radio Times* used a front cover image of Saga in her recognisable overcoat with the anchor 'Hot Scandinavian dramas for cold winter nights'
- There were international remakes of *The Bridge* illustrating its success, these included the Anglo/French production *The Tunnel* and the US version *The Bridge* set on the US Mexican border and produced by the FX network.